

Sahr David THOMAS-GBATTA MEng CEng MICE

Associate Director

PROFILE

Sahr is passionate, versatile, and detail-driven Chartered Structural Engineer (CEng) with over 10 years of design consultancy experience across both the private and public sectors, covering bridge engineering, building structures, and multidisciplinary infrastructure projects. I am skilled in structural assessment, analysis, modelling, and design across concrete, steel, timber, and masonry, with experience in both new-build and refurbishment environments.

My background includes complex bridge inspections, strengthening and remediation design, and structural calculations and alteration works for existing and new buildings. I combine strong technical capability with clear communication, high-quality reporting, and a practical, solution-focused approach. I work effectively with clients, contractors, and multidisciplinary teams to deliver safe, compliant, and buildable engineering solutions.

CORE SKILLS

- Experience in highways infrastructure conceptual & detailed bridge design construction and delivery methods
- Bridge and building design, assessment, strengthening, and rehabilitation
- Knowledge and application of various technical standards, asset policies and strategies
- Understanding of value management processes, asset decision making and delivery methods
- Computer analysis programs (CAD, Autodesk Structural Bridge Design, LUSAS, MIDAS, Robot Structures, Tedds, Teckla Structures)
- BIM, CAD, and parametric design tools (Revit, Civil 3D,)
- Asset management and lifecycle planning
- Risk, safety, and sustainability in infrastructure design
- Structures inspections- Buildings and Bridges
- Effective leadership in modern-day organisations – ILM Level 5 Certificate in Leadership and Management (2023)
- Health & Safety, Risk Management, Sustainability training

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

❖ TIFAND LIMITED — *(November 2024 – Present)*

Associate Director

- Managing structural design engineering projects from initial design through completion
- Assessing existing structures and recommending appropriate solutions and remedial works designs if required
- Producing structural design calculations, specifications and technical reports
- Evaluating temporary works designs integration with permanent works, and assessing impacts and interface on permanent works
- Providing technical guidance on multi-disciplinary teams of major projects
- Producing structural appraisals, asset mitigation reports and monitoring plans

❖ NATIONAL HIGHWAYS — *(July 2022 – February 2024)*

Principal Design Engineer

- Planned, managed, and delivered a portfolio of highway structure projects within the region's five-years capital and significant schemes programs, across all stages of the project lifecycle.
- Developed asset needs and managing project, as well as external contractors and Consultants.
- Prepared project briefs and commissioning works to Consultants.
- Managed and overseen the adherence to governance, quality assurance, health and safety standards, as well as technical and specialist standards across the supply chain.
- Worked closely with the Regional Management Team, Programme Delivery Managers, stakeholders, suppliers, and National Highways teams to maintain collaborative relationships and ensuring that strategic and delivery objectives are fully understood. I reported and reviewed delivery performance, agreeing on solutions that resolve complex issues, and preparing project business cases.
- Managed scheme budget, program reporting and risk management, ensuring compliance with health, safety, and environmental legislation. I oversee the management of risks, issues, dependencies, and constraints associated with the schemes.
- Provided specialist technical expertise and assurance in the development of early solutions for asset renewal and improvement schemes through value management process and evaluation options studies.
- Developed and recommending best practice methods for the identification and evaluation of asset condition and future needs to support the ongoing development of asset maintenance strategies.

Key Projects & involvement

- M55 D'Upton Lane bridge strengthening (Preliminary design stage – bridge substructure and deck strengthening)

- M55 Broughton Circle Bridge UPGRADE (Significant structures Renewal at optioning stage)
- IAMIS update for ALSAT Abnormal load tool commissioning and scheme management
- Production of CS 470; A595 Blackbeck Beckermest bridge, M55 Broughton Circle and the M55 D'Urton Lane Bridge sub standard edge beams
- Management of M6 Carnforth Interchange Bridges half joint assessment
- Structures on call Engineer

❖ CITY OF BRADFORD METROPOLITAN DISTRICT COUNCIL (CBMDC) Structures Unit — (May 2019 – July 2022)

Senior Design Engineer

Key Roles – Bridges

- Delivered design and assessment leadership on medium-to-large scale infrastructure projects, including highway structures and urban infrastructures.
- Lead multidisciplinary design teams, coordinating with geotechnical, highways and environmental specialists
- Provided asset owner support/as key client interface, developing project briefs, securing project funds, and presenting technical proposals.
- Reviewed and approved structural calculations, drawings, and design deliverables, ensuring compliance with codes and client specifications.
- Provided technical authority, approving calculations, drawings & reports.
- Lead roll on bridge assessment projects, including modelling, data analysis, and reporting.
- Drove digital engineering adoption, reducing design iterations and errors.
- Mentored and trained engineers, establishing best practice in bridge design and assessment, and digital workflows as well as guiding their professional development.
- Reviewed and authorised structures inspection report.

Key Roles - Buildings

- Various highway and footbridge inspections.
- Dockfield footbridge assessment and the design of interim support measures.
- Technical supports to the Architecture and the Building Control Teams.
- Support to Shipley Town Centre redevelopment scheme
- Lead designer of the Town Center Market footbridge and Carpark as part of the Kirklees Council's
- Holmfirth Town assess regeneration scheme

Key Projects & involvement: Bridges and Urban infrastructures

- Various highway and footbridge inspections.
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- Lead designer of the Town Center Market footbridge and Carpark as part of the Kirklees Council's
- Holmfirth Town assess regeneration scheme

❖ PETER WADE CONSULTANCY — *(December 2018 – April 2019)*

Senior Structural Engineer

- Designed structural solutions for residential and commercial projects, including beam design, wall removals, and foundation checks.
- Interpreting drawings (architectural & structural)
- Preparing technical reports
- Structural calculations (steel, concrete, timber, masonry)
- Client communication and stakeholder coordination as well as support to multidisciplinary teams across residential, commercial, and infrastructure projects.
- Assessed building pathology and defect diagnosis, ,stability, and compliance with current standards
- Provided technical advice to architects, contractors, and clients during design and construction stages.
- Site inspections and condition surveys Assisted with building surveys, structural inspections, and preparation of technical documentation.
- Contributed to feasibility studies and option appraisals for refurbishment and infrastructure renewal schemes.
- Developed checklists, risk matrices, and templates to streamline inspection and reporting workflows.
- Gained experience across reinforced concrete, steel, timber, and masonry design principles
- Structural assessment and reporting
- Project management and workflow organisation

❖ JACOBS UK Ltd — *(May 2014 – December 2018)*

Graduate Engineer

Key Roles

- Prepared structural calculations and detailed design drawings for highway structures.
- Conduct structural assessments for concrete and steel highway bridges, including half-joint structures, integral bridges, and multi-span decks.
- Developed Midas Civil models to assess load capacity, structural behaviour, and strengthening requirements.
- Production of design and assessment Approval in Principle (AIP) documents for several schemes
- Assisted in tender preparation, project proposals, and client presentations.
- Produced feasibility studies, concept, preliminary and detailed designs, and technical reports
- Supported site teams with design queries and temporary works coordination.
- Prepared remediation strategies including strengthening, bearing replacement, concrete repair, and load management.

- Conducted structures general, principal inspections and reporting on the structures condition
- Developed rehabilitation/renewal strategy for highway bridges, minor structures and gantries.
- Collaborated with asset managers and contractors to prioritise risks and plan interventions

Key Projects

- Telent National Road Telecommunication Structures Service technical approval , (June 2018 – November 2018)
- M20 & M23 Smart Motorway Programme (March 2016 – February 2018)
- M62 Ouse Bridge bearing replacement (2016 – 2017)
- M1 Junction 19 upgrade (2016)
- A500 Widening (February 2016 – May 2016)
- M6 Junction improvement (Oct 2015- feb 2016)
- Principle Bridge Inspection (December 2014 – April 2015) (Durham County Council)

EDUCATION & TRAINING

Master of Engineering (MEng) Civil & Structural Engineering – University of Bradford (2014)

LANGUAGES

Fluent English

HOBBIES AND INTEREST

Tennis / Swimming